

Akur8

AI-powered actuarial pricing and reserving platform for insurance carriers

Paris, France · Founded 2018 · Series C · \$180M total raised

1. COMPANY SNAPSHOT

Company	Akur8	Stage	Series C
URL	akur8.com	Last Round	\$120M Sep 2024 One Peak (lead)
HQ	Paris, France	Total Raised	\$180M cumulative
Founded	2018 (product launched 2019)	FTEs	~200+ across 8 offices

2. WHAT THEY DO

Akur8 is a SaaS actuarial platform that replaces spreadsheet-based and legacy GLM workflows with transparent machine learning models for non-life insurance pricing, reserving, and optimisation. Insurers use the platform to build, validate, and deploy pricing models faster and with greater statistical rigour than traditional tools allow, while retaining full actuarial interpretability and regulatory auditability. The business model is SaaS subscription, with contracts typically structured per actuarial user or per line of business.

3. TRACTION SIGNALS

- **350+ insurer clients** across 40+ countries, including AXA, Generali, Munich Re, MAPFRE, Tokio Marine, and MS&AD.; [akur8.com/about, 2026]
- **3,000+ active actuarial users** on the platform daily. [akur8.com]
- **~\$20.5M revenue in 2024**, approximately doubling YoY; triple-digit organic growth every year since launch. [Latka, 2025; Issuu annual report 2024]
- **Geographic footprint:** 8 offices including Tokyo (APAC hub), NY, Atlanta, Montreal. Tune Protect (Malaysia) signed April 2026. [akur8.com/news]
- **Product expansion:** Acquired Arius (reserving, 2024) and Slope Software (life/annuity, 2025), shifting from single-product to full actuarial platform.
- **Guidewire Software** (IAG's core policy admin platform vendor) is a strategic investor and participating Series C backer. [GlobeNewswire, Sep 2024]

4. TEAM

Samuel Falmagne (CEO, co-founder) — 15 years at IBM in international sales and general management, then Head of Sales at Shift Technology (AI fraud detection unicorn), where he led international expansion. Founder-market fit: outsider-turned-insider with deep distribution expertise in insurance AI.

Guillaume Beraud-Sudreau (co-founder, Head of Product and Data Science) — leads the technical product and ML research function; deep actuarial and data science background from the original 4-year R&D; programme.

Thomas Holmes (Chief Actuary, FCAS) — credentialed actuary providing regulatory legitimacy and actuarial community trust. Directly addresses buyer-side scepticism around ML interpretability.

Classification: Hybrid. Falmagne brings commercial and insurtech distribution expertise; Beraud-Sudreau brings technical depth; Holmes bridges the actuarial credibility gap. Team composition suits the sales-intensity of enterprise SaaS into conservative buyers.

5. MARKET CONTEXT

The global actuarial and insurance pricing software market is estimated at \$3-5B TAM growing ~12-15% CAGR, driven by regulatory pressure for model explainability, rising combined ratios forcing pricing precision, and retirement of legacy GLM tools. The category is in active growth phase: no dominant global SaaS player has emerged, creating a real land-grab dynamic.

Closest alternatives: Earnix (Israel, \$75M+ raised, pricing optimisation with deployment focus), hyperexponential (UK, specialty/commercial lines), Quantee (UK, AI-native pricing). None have Akur8's breadth of carrier logos or its full actuarial suite (pricing + reserving + life). Guidewire and Majesco serve adjacent layers but are not direct pricing-model competitors.

Timing: Climate-driven loss inflation and rising combined ratios across P&C; globally have made pricing accuracy a board-level priority. The Australian market is acutely exposed to this dynamic. IAG's own Ambition 2030 strategy targets \$25B in premiums, which requires pricing infrastructure that scales without proportional headcount growth.

6. STRATEGIC RELEVANCE TO IAG

IAGFV Focus	Enterprise Tech (primary); InsurTech
IAG BU Fit	Group Actuarial, RIA, IIA, NZ (pricing teams)
Signal	HIGH
Pathway	Pricing platform layer; Guidewire integration bridge
Investor flag	Guidewire (IAG's core vendor) is existing strategic investor

IAG recently consolidated its pricing platforms from 8 to 1 and completed migration of 6M+ policies. This reduces displacement risk for Akur8 but creates a clear opening for a *model-building layer* that sits on top of IAG's consolidated rating engine, rather than competing with it. The Guidewire relationship is the warmest commercial entry point: Guidewire's PartnerConnect ecosystem includes Akur8, and IAG's Guidewire relationship is long-standing.

7. KEY RISKS

- R1** Displacement risk is low but integration risk is real: IAG has consolidated to a single pricing platform on AWS. Akur8 would need to demonstrate clean integration with IAG's existing rating engine and data infrastructure, not merely offer a standalone model-building tool.
- R2** APAC carrier penetration is thin: Akur8's named Asia-Pacific logos are Tokio Marine and MS&AD; (Japanese), with Tune Protect (Malaysia) signed April 2026. No Australian carrier is publicly referenced. The Tokyo office is a proxy for APAC coverage, not demonstrated Australian market presence.
- R3** Competitive risk from Earnix and hyperexponential: Earnix has a longer track record with carrier deployments and a more mature pricing-optimisation layer; hyperexponential has strong specialty lines traction in Lloyd's market and is expanding. Both are well-capitalised.
- R4** Platform breadth introduces execution risk: three acquisitions in under 18 months (Arius, Slope Software) means Akur8 is managing multi-product integration at the same time as international expansion. Quality and support degradation is a real near-term risk.
- R5** Valuation and capital intensity: at \$180M raised with ~\$20M revenue, the implied revenue multiple is elevated even at 100% growth. If growth decelerates post-Series C — a common pattern after rapid ARR inflation in early years — the next round dynamic will be materially harder.

8. KEY QUESTIONS

VENTURE LENS

Q1 What is current net revenue retention across the insurer cohort? What is driving churn where it occurs, and is it technical (integration failure) or commercial (pricing tool replaced by internal build)?

Q2 What does the path to contribution margin positive look like, and at what ACV per client does a new logo become economically positive net of implementation cost?

Q3 How does CAC evolve as the team moves beyond European carriers into Asia-Pacific, where actuarial norms and regulatory requirements differ materially from the EU model?

PRODUCT AND MOATS

Q4 What proprietary data assets or network effects prevent a well-resourced incumbent (Guidewire, Majesco, Duck Creek) from building equivalent ML model tooling into their existing policy admin platforms within 24 months?

Q5 How does the model interpretability guarantee hold up under Australian APRA regulatory review? Has any carrier used Akur8 outputs in a regulatory submission, and what was the outcome?

Q6 Now that Akur8 is building its own rating engine (Deploy module), how does it position against carriers that have recently invested in consolidating their own rating infrastructure? Is the message 'replace' or 'augment'?

IAGFV LENS

Q7 Given Guidewire's investment in Akur8 and IAG's long-standing Guidewire relationship, is there a structured Guidewire PartnerConnect pathway into IAG's actuarial team, or has that conversation already been initiated?

Q8 Which IAG lines of business (motor, home, commercial) represent the most natural initial beachhead, and what is the minimum viable proof point an IAG actuarial team would need to see before committing to a pilot?

9. Initial Take

Akur8 is one of the most credible enterprise actuarial platforms in market: real revenue, real carrier logos, a defensible technical differentiation in ML interpretability, and a product trajectory that is expanding from pricing into the full actuarial stack. The Guidewire strategic investment is the most commercially actionable signal for IAG: it means a warm pathway already exists through an existing vendor relationship, avoiding the cold outreach problem that blocks most InsurTech evaluations. The key question mark is APAC market presence: Akur8 has no Australian carrier reference, and IAG has recently completed a major pricing platform consolidation that may reduce near-term urgency among internal actuarial teams. This warrants a first meeting with the commercial team, with IAG's Guidewire relationship used as the entry point and a specific ask for an Australian carrier reference or equivalent APAC proof point.